basic education
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REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

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TO: **HEADS OF PROVINCIAL EDUCATION DEPARTMENTS**
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SOUTH AFRICAN COMPREHENSIVE ASSESSMENT INSTITUTE (SACAI)
INDEPENDENT SCHOOLS ASSOCIATION OF SOUTHERN AFRICA (ISASA)
SCHOOL GOVERNING BODIES (SGB) ASSOCIATIONS
NATIONAL TEACHER ORGANISATIONS

CIRCULAR S19 of 2025: RETENTION OF GRADES R-12 2023/2024 ANNUAL TEACHING PLANS INCLUDING REVISED SCHOOL BASED AND EXAMINATIONS FOR 2026 ACADEMIC YEAR

1. The Department issued Circular S33 OF 2022. The circular pertains to the Annual Teaching Plans (ATPs) for 2023/2024 Academic year.

2. The 2023 Annual Teaching Plans for grades R-12 provided guidance to the implementation of the recovery of learning. The plans were implemented from January 2023 until the date of revocation.

3. The Annual Teaching Plans were accompanied by revised School -Based Assessment and examination weightings, and other key assessment requirements for implementation.

4. Circular **S15 of 2024** was issued to reiterate retention of 2023/2024 Annual Teaching Plans, Revised weightings and requirements to the School-Based Assessment for learners in grades R-12, will continue to be implemented in 2025.

5. The purpose of this Circular, **S19 of 2025**, is to inform the provincial education departments and all stakeholders that the contents of Circular **S33 of 2022** remain applicable for 2026 with the following exclusions:

    - The Retention of the ATPs **excludes CAT and IT, Natural Sciences & Mathematics for Intermediate and Senior Phases.**
    - DG submission was approved in September on review of **CAT and IT** technologies to accommodate new trends and new peripherals. This has had an impact on the ATPs for these subjects. Subsequently, information regarding the update of CAT & IT to update technologies was communicated through **Circular S9 of 2025**.
    - For **Natural Sciences, Natural Sciences & Technology (Grades 4-9) and Mathematics (Grades 4-5 & 8-9),** a new directive is necessary. This is to accommodate certain topics that were removed (content reduction) during Covid19, which are being brought back in preparation for the upcoming Trends in International Mathematics and Science Study happening in 2027.
    - This should not be perceived as teaching for testing, but rather to build on specific foundational knowledge necessary for competing with learners of the same grades internationally.

6. **Circular 33 of 2022** is attached for ease of reference.

7. You are kindly requested to bring the content of this Circular to the attention of all provincial and district officials, principals, teachers of both public and independent schools, and other relevant stakeholders.

8. The Annual Teaching Plans are available on the DBE website: https://www.education.gov.za

Yours sincerely



MR HM MWELI
DIRECTOR-GENERAL
DATE: 11/12/2025